

This illustration represents the American Hotel as one of three historic brick buildings located on the east side of Main Street in Sag Harbor. Flanked by Ivans shoe store and the Municipal Building, the American Hotel stands as a prominent example of post-1845 fire reconstruction. Its design is symmetrical and balanced, with three floors, tall sash windows, and a flat roofline accentuated by a cornice.

The accompanying text explains that the American Hotel was built on the site of James Howells Inn, one of Sag Harbors earliest known inns. This location was notable during the Revolutionary War when British officers were captured here by Colonel Meigs and his men. James Howell, an early settler of Sag Harbor, had established one of the villages first residential and commercial sites at this very corner.

From 1825 until the great fire of 1845, Nathan Tinker operated a cabinetmaking shop here. After the fire, he chose to construct a brick residence on the same lot. The resulting building, completed in 1846, was originally a two-family home for Tinker and his son. In 1876, the structure was converted into a hotel, which it has remained ever since. Today, it also houses a restaurant and bar.

Aesthetic details are also noted: the Victorian porch was added in 1876, contributing charm and functionality to the facade. At one point, a second-story balcony extended the full width of the building. While some architectural elements have changed over time, key historic features such as a brownstone parapet and a Gothic cornice fragment remain as testaments to the buildings layered evolution.

In summary, the illustration and text together illustrate how the American Hotel functions as both a historical artifact and a living business. Its architecture tells a story of adaptation and continuity, linking Sag Harbors colonial past with its 19th-century industrial and hospitality heritage.